

ROB PARKER

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SUMMARY

Technology executive with 25+ years of engineering experience, including 10+ years in senior leadership roles at B2B SaaS companies, architecting scalable products and building high-performance distributed development teams. Most recently, directed teams that built and shipped SugarAI's multi-tenant AI platform on AWS Bedrock, spanning AI/ML, Data Platform, and Identity Management. Track record of scaling engineering organizations while delivering measurable outcomes: 350% increase in system throughput, 25% cost reduction, and 20% increase in developer velocity through AI enablement to scale toward agentic development workflows. Prior experience as CTO at Salesfusion; led the technical track of acquisition by SugarCRM. Targeting Director or VP of Engineering roles at AI-forward companies.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Director of Engineering SugarAI (formerly SugarCRM)

January 2021 – March 2026 | Atlanta, GA

- Led AI-native platform engineering and data science teams for \$100M+ SaaS CRM company (500 employees), managing a global organization of 26 engineers through 5 managers.
- Led the design and delivery of a multi-tenant AI platform on AWS Bedrock through beta release, encompassing RAG pipelines, agent orchestration, prompt management, and LLM observability across the SugarAI product suite.
- Built a three-tier AI adoption framework and drove GitHub Copilot deployment across the engineering organization, delivering a measured 20% increase in developer velocity; established evaluation and governance infrastructure for expanded GAI tooling to scale toward agentic workflows.
- Led modernization from monolithic .NET to containerized Python microservices and AWS serverless architecture (ECS, Lambda, Step Functions), increasing system throughput by 350% while reducing infrastructure costs by 25%.
- Delivered complex, multi-team product roadmaps on time and within budget, driving 17+ major releases annually with less than 10% sprint variance and 5% carryover.
- Scaled global engineering organization by 150%, with 90% retention; mentored 8 engineers into senior/staff roles and promoted 3 to engineering manager positions.
- Maintained an 80% DX developer experience score, measuring and sustaining engineering team health through a period of rapid organizational growth.
- Implemented quality-first engineering with automated testing frameworks (Cypress, Virtuoso, PyTest) achieving 90% code coverage across critical platform components.
- Drove platform integration strategy unifying disparate systems into cohesive CRM ecosystem, supporting a 25% improvement in customer retention metrics.
- Managed \$2M annual engineering budget and P&L responsibility for platform infrastructure, optimizing cloud spend and vendor contracts.

Director of Engineering SugarAI (formerly SugarCRM)

May 2019 – January 2021 | Atlanta, GA

- Transitioned directly from CTO of acquired Salesfusion into this role to lead the full technology integration, owning the roadmap for a 12-person engineering team and 300+ B2B customer accounts.
- Migrated the Salesfusion platform to SugarCRM infrastructure within 6 months, unifying code repositories, CI/CD pipelines, and deployment processes across both organizations, achieving 100% of integration milestones on schedule.
- Maintained product velocity and team stability throughout the acquisition, achieving 92% employee retention during the transition.

Chief Technology Officer Salesfusion

January 2019 – May 2019 | Atlanta, GA

- Served as CTO through SugarCRM's acquisition of Salesfusion; led the full technical track of the transaction, defining the organization integration strategy and technical roadmap. Completed org integration on schedule in 12 weeks with zero customer churn.

- Built and executed technical roadmap for platform scalability, security hardening, and performance improvements, achieving SOC 2 Type II and ISO 27001 certification, significantly improving platform response times, and maintaining 99.95% uptime SLA.
- Managed 12-person engineering team across frontend (Angular), backend (Python), and DevOps disciplines.

Director of Engineering / Lead Software Engineer

Salesfusion

November 2015 – January 2019 | Atlanta, GA

- Advanced from Lead Software Engineer to Director of Engineering, demonstrating strong technical and leadership capabilities.
- Established development methodologies (Agile/Scrum), code quality standards (80% test coverage), and technical best practices, improving deployment frequency from quarterly to bi-weekly.
- Architected marketing automation features processing 2M+ emails daily.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer / Technical Team Lead — athenahealth (2015)

Led re-platforming of an acquired EHR system with 50,000+ users to private cloud, improving deployment frequency from monthly to weekly and reducing MTTR from 4 hours to 45 minutes.

Software Architect / Systems Team Lead — M2SYS Technology

Architected an enterprise biometric identity platform scaled to 80M+ records, supporting fingerprint, iris, and vascular recognition across healthcare and government organizations with 99.99% availability.

Senior Software Engineer — Qcept Technologies

Designed semiconductor metrology software for sub-100nm wafer defect detection, improving inspection throughput and significantly reducing false positive rates.

Senior Software Engineer — Cisco Systems

Built embedded middleware for multi-tuner set-top boxes managing 6 concurrent HD streams across 2M+ deployed cable operator devices.

EDUCATION

Master of Science, Computer Science — Georgia Institute of Technology

Bachelor of Science, Computer Information Systems — Clemson University

SKILLS

AI & Platform: AWS Bedrock, RAG Pipeline Design, LLM Evaluation, Agentic Frameworks (LangGraph, CrewAI), Multi-Tenant SaaS Platforms, AI Observability & Cost Governance, Prompt Management

Cloud & Architecture: Cloud-Native Architecture, Microservices, Serverless Computing, AWS (ECS, Lambda, Step Functions, DynamoDB), DevOps & CI/CD, Site Reliability Engineering, Performance Optimization

Engineering Leadership: Executive Engineering Leadership, Team Scaling & Retention, Technical Mentorship, Strategic Planning, Cross-Functional Collaboration, Stakeholder Management, Change Management, M&A Technical Due Diligence, Budget & P&L Management

Development: Roadmap Planning & Execution, Product Delivery, Automated Testing (Cypress, Virtuoso, PyTest), API & Systems Integration, Data Engineering & ETL Pipelines, Agile & Scrum Methodologies